

Best Practices for Writing Clean HTML

1. Use Proper Indentation

Indent nested elements for better readability.

```
<ul>
  <li>Item 1</li>
  <li>Item 2</li>
</ul>
```

2. Always Close Your Tags

Even if some tags are optional, it's best to close them properly.

```
<p>This is correct.</p>
```

3. Use Meaningful Tag Structure

Use semantic tags like `<header>`, `<main>`, `<footer>` instead of relying only on `<div>`.

4. Include alt Text for Images

This improves accessibility and helps screen readers understand image content.

```

```

5. Use Lowercase for Tags and Attributes

HTML is not case-sensitive, but using lowercase is the standard.

```
<!-- Good -->  
<input type="text">  
  
<!-- Avoid -->  
<INPUT TYPE="TEXT">
```

6. Organize Your Code

Keep your HTML structured by grouping related elements together. Use comments to separate sections.

```
<!-- Navigation -->  
<nav>...</nav>  
  
<!-- Main Content -->  
<main>...</main>
```

7. Don't Use Inline Styles (if possible)

Avoid putting CSS styles directly into HTML tags. Use external CSS files instead.

```
<!-- Avoid -->
<p style="color: red;">Red text</p>

<!-- Prefer -->
<p class="red-text">Red text</p>
```

8. Validate Your HTML

Use tools like [W3C HTML Validator](#) to check for errors in your code.

9. Keep File Names Simple and Clear

Use lowercase letters, dashes instead of spaces, and meaningful names.

```
✓ about-us.html
✗ About Us!.html
```

10. Comment Your Code (When Needed)

Use comments to explain complex sections or to label page areas.

```
<!-- Contact Form -->
<form>...</form>
```

Tip

Clean HTML is easier to read, debug, maintain, and scale as your website grows.